

Word family: **press / pressed / pressing / pressure / pressurize**

Base word: press

Past tense: pressed

Past participle: pressed

Related forms: pressing, pressure, pressurize / pressurise

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / adjective (相關形式)

Your sentence:

> “It was like someone had **pressed** a mute button on the outside world, and that image really stayed with me.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **press** means to **push a button with your finger so that a machine or function is activated**.

繁體中文: **用手指向按鈕施加壓力, 把它按下, 從而啟動某項功能**

中文翻譯:

> “It was like someone had pressed a mute button on the outside world...”

「那感覺就像有人**按下了外界的靜音按鈕**一樣.....」

press a button = 按下按鈕, 使某項功能啟動

1. **press + button/key/switch (按鈕／按鍵／開關) — 按下; 按動**

This is the meaning in your original sentence.

Meaning: To push a button, key, or switch with your finger or hand in order to operate something.

Practice 1 — Original

> “It was like someone had **pressed** a mute button on the outside world.”

「那感覺就像有人**按下了外界的靜音按鈕**一樣。」

Practice 2

> “**Press** the green button to start the machine.”

「**按下**綠色按鈕便可啟動機器。」

Practice 3

> “She **pressed** a key on the keyboard.”

「她**按了一下**鍵盤上的按鍵。」

press a button/key = 用手指或手向按鈕／按鍵施加壓力，使其啟動相應功能

2. **press + object/body part against/on something (物件／身體部位) — 壓; 按; 貼緊**

Meaning: To push something firmly against another surface.

Practice 4

> “She **pressed** her hand against the glass.”

「她把手**緊緊按在玻璃上**。」

Practice 5

> “He **pressed** the cloth onto the wound.”

「他把布**緊壓在傷口上**。」

press = 對某物施加持續或較明顯的力量，使它緊貼另一個表面

3. **press + object downward/together (物件) — 壓緊; 擠壓; 把.....壓在一起**

Meaning: To apply force so that something becomes flatter, tighter, or more compact.

Practice 6

> “**Press** the dough flat with your hands.”

「用手把麵糰**壓平**。」

Practice 7

> “The machine **presses** the material into blocks.”

「機器把材料**壓製成塊狀**。」

press = 施加力量, 使物件變平、變緊密或被壓製成某種形狀

4. **press** + clothes/fabric (衣物／布料) — 熨燙; 壓平皺褶

Meaning: To make clothes or fabric smooth, usually with an iron or pressing machine.

Practice 8

> “He **pressed** his shirt before the interview.”

「他在面試前把襯衫**熨平**。」

Practice 9

> “The trousers had been carefully **pressed**.”

「那條褲子已被仔細**熨燙平整**。」

press clothes = 用熨斗或壓燙設備把衣物皺褶弄平

5. **press** + person + for something / to do something (人 + 要求) — 催促; 施壓要求

Meaning: To strongly urge someone to do something or provide something.

Practice 10

> “Reporters **pressed** the minister for an answer.”

「記者不斷**向部長施壓**, 要求作出回答。」

Practice 11

> “The manager **pressed** the team to finish the work on time.”

「經理**催促並施壓要求**團隊**準時完成**工作。」

****press someone = 持續或強烈地向某人提出要求, 使其作出行動或回應****

This is figuratively connected to physical pressure: instead of pushing something physically, you are ****putting pressure on a person****.

6. ****press + issue/point/case (議題／觀點／要求) — 積極提出; 堅持推動****

****Meaning:**** To continue arguing for, pursuing, or emphasizing something strongly.

Practice 12

> “She decided not to ****press**** the issue any further.”

「她決定不再繼續****追究／堅持推動這個問題****。」

Practice 13

> “The lawyer ****pressed**** his argument strongly.”

「律師有力地****堅持並推進自己的論點****。」

****press an issue/point = 持續而積極地提出、追究或推動某項主張****

7. ****press charges (法律) — 提出刑事控告; 要求追究刑事責任****

This is an important fixed legal expression.

Practice 14

> “The victim decided to ****press charges****.”

「受害人決定****提出刑事控告／要求追究刑事責任****。」

Practice 15

> “She chose not to ****press charges**** after the incident.”

「事件發生後, 她選擇不****提出刑事控告****。」

****press charges = 正式要求刑事司法程序追究某人的涉嫌犯罪行為****

The exact procedure varies by jurisdiction, but this is the standard English expression.

8. **press** = newspapers/news media (新聞媒體) — 新聞界; 傳媒

Here, **the press** is a noun.

Meaning: Newspapers, journalists, and news organizations considered collectively.

Practice 16

> “The story attracted a lot of attention from the **press**.”

「這則新聞吸引了**新聞媒體**的大量關注。」

Practice 17

> “The company refused to comment to the **press**.”

「公司拒絕向**傳媒／新聞界**發表評論。」

the press = 報章、記者及新聞機構整體

9. **press** = journalists/reporters as a group (記者群體) — 記者; 傳媒記者

Closely related to #8, but often refers more concretely to the journalists present.

Practice 18

> “The **press** gathered outside the courthouse.”

「大批**記者**聚集在法院外。」

Practice 19

> “Security kept the **press** away from the entrance.”

「保安阻止**記者群**靠近入口。」

the press = 在現場採訪或報道事件的記者群體

I would treat #8 and #9 as two contextual branches of the same media sense.

10. **press** = printing machine (印刷設備) — 印刷機

Meaning: A machine used for printing books, newspapers, or other material.

Practice 20

> “The newspaper uses a modern printing **press**.”

「這份報章使用現代化的**印刷機**。」

Practice 21

> “The invention of the printing **press** transformed communication.”

「**印刷機**的發明徹底改變了資訊傳播。」

printing press = 用來大量印刷文字或圖像的機器

11. **press** = publishing organization (出版社) — 出版社

Meaning: A company or institution that publishes books or academic works.

Practice 22

> “The book was published by a university **press**.”

「這本書由一間大學**出版社**出版。」

Practice 23

> “The manuscript was accepted by a major academic **press**.”

「這份手稿獲一家大型學術**出版社**接納。」

press = 負責出版書籍或學術作品的出版機構

Common examples:

* university press

* academic press

12. **press = machine that applies force (壓製機／壓床) — 壓機; 壓製設備**

This is the broader machinery sense behind **printing press**.

Practice 24

> “The metal is shaped using a hydraulic **press**.”

「金屬利用液壓**壓機**塑形成形。」

Practice 25

> “The factory installed a new industrial **press**.”

「工廠安裝了一部新的工業**壓製機**。」

press = 利用強大壓力來壓縮、塑形或加工材料的機械設備

13. **press = crowd pushing closely together (人群擠迫) — 擁擠的人群; 擠壓**

This noun use is less common in everyday conversation but still current, especially in literary/formal descriptions.

Practice 26

> “He struggled through the **press** of people.”

「他艱難地穿過**密集擁擠的人群**。」

Practice 27

> “She was caught in the **press** near the entrance.”

「她在入口附近被困在**互相擠壓的人群中**。」

press = 大量人緊密擠在一起所形成的擁擠狀態／人群

14. **pressed = under time/money/resource pressure (時間／金錢／資源) — 時間緊迫的; 手頭拮据的**

A very useful adjective-like use.

Practice 28

> “I’m a little **pressed for time** today.”

「我今天**時間很緊迫, 沒有多少時間可用**。」

Practice 29

> “The organization is **pressed for cash**.”

「這個機構目前**資金緊絀／手頭缺乏現金**。」

pressed for + resource = 某種時間、金錢或資源不足, 因而感到壓力

Common patterns:

* **pressed for time** = 時間緊迫

* **pressed for cash** = 現金不足

* **hard-pressed** = 承受很大壓力／處境艱難

15. **hard-pressed = facing serious difficulty or pressure — 處境艱難的; 承受很大壓力的**

Useful family extension.

Practice 30

> “Small businesses are **hard-pressed** to absorb the higher costs.”

「小企業很難承受較高成本, 正處於**壓力很大的艱難處境**。」

Practice 31

> “The hospital staff are already **hard-pressed**.”

「醫院員工已經**工作壓力極大、人手和資源相當緊張**。」

****hard-pressed = 因資源、時間或困難而受到很大壓力的****

16. ****pressing = urgent and needing immediate attention (問題／需要) — 緊迫的; 急需處理的****

Here, ****pressing**** is an adjective.

Practice 32

> “We have more ****pressing**** problems to deal with.”

「我們有更****緊迫、需要立即處理的問題****。」

Practice 33

> “Housing is a ****pressing**** concern in the city.”

「住屋是這座城市一個****急需處理的重要問題****。」

****pressing = 因時間或重要性而不能拖延、需要盡快處理的****

17. ****pressure = physical force applied to something (物理壓力) — 壓力; 壓強****

****Meaning:**** Force applied to a surface, or force exerted within a fluid or gas.

Practice 34

> “Apply gentle ****pressure**** to the wound.”

「在傷口上施加輕微的****壓力****。」

Practice 35

> “The tyre ****pressure**** is too low.”

「輪胎的****氣壓****太低。」

****pressure = 施加在物體表面的力量, 或液體／氣體內部產生的壓強****

18. **pressure = psychological/social demand (心理／工作／社會壓力) — 壓力; 逼迫感**

Practice 36

> “She works well under **pressure**.”

「她在**壓力之下**仍能有良好表現。」

Practice 37

> “Students often feel **pressure** to achieve high grades.”

「學生經常感受到取得高分的**心理／社會壓力**。」

pressure = 因要求、責任、期望或困難而產生的心理負擔

19. **pressure = attempt to influence someone (施壓) — 壓力; 迫使某人行動的影響力**

Practice 38

> “The company came under **pressure** to change its policy.”

「公司受到**外界施壓**，被要求改變政策。」

Practice 39

> “Public **pressure** led to a review of the decision.”

「公眾的**施壓和要求**促使當局重新檢視該決定。」

pressure = 用要求、輿論或影響力迫使某人／機構作出改變

20. **pressurized / pressurised = containing controlled air/gas pressure (加壓的) — 加壓的; 維持氣壓的**

Practice 40

> “The aircraft cabin is **pressurized**.”

「飛機客艙是**經過加壓、維持適當氣壓的**。」

Practice 41

> “The liquid is stored in a **pressurized** container.”

「液體儲存在一個**加壓容器**內。」

pressurized = 內部氣體或液體被維持在高於外界或特定設定的壓力狀態

21. **pressurize + person(人)** — 向某人施壓; 迫使

Especially common in British English as **pressurise**.

Practice 42

> “They tried to **pressurize** him into accepting the offer.”

「他們試圖**向他施壓**, 迫使他接受這項提議。」

Practice 43

> “Don’t let anyone **pressurize** you into making a quick decision.”

「不要讓任何人**施壓**迫使你匆忙作決定。」

pressurize someone = 用心理、社會或其他壓力迫使某人作出某個決定

Important distinction: **press vs push**

These overlap, but their focus differs.

push

= use force to move something away or forward

> “Push the door.”

「把門**推開**。」

press

= apply force directly onto a surface, often without moving it very far

> “Press the button.”

「**按下**按鈕。」

A button is usually **pressed**, not simply *pushed*, although **push the button** is also possible.

Important distinction: **press** vs **click**

For computers and devices:

press

Usually refers to a physical key or button.

> “Press Enter.”

「按下 Enter 鍵。」

click

Usually refers to selecting something with a mouse/touchpad, or sometimes tapping a digital interface.

> “Click the link.”

「點擊連結。」

So:

* physical keyboard key → **press**

* webpage link → usually **click**

Important distinction: **press** vs **squeeze**

press

= apply force onto something

squeeze

= apply pressure from opposite sides, often compressing something

> “Press the button.”

「按下按鈕。」

> “Squeeze the lemon.”

「擠壓檸檬。」

Important distinction: **pressing vs pressured**

pressing

describes something **urgent**

> “a pressing issue”

「一個急需處理的問題」

pressured

describes someone **feeling under pressure**

> “I feel pressured.”

「我感到受到壓力／被迫。」

Very different:

* **pressing problem** → 問題很急

* **pressured person** → 人感到壓力

Important distinction: **press vs pressure**

press

Verb:

> “They pressed him for an answer.”

「他們向他施壓要求回答。」

pressure

Noun:

> “He was under pressure to answer.”

「他受到回答問題的壓力。」

pressure can also be a verb:

> “They pressured him to answer.”

「他們向他施壓，要求他回答。」

In everyday English, **pressure someone** is very common.

Family-extension note

Following our updated Golden Manual, these common extensions are worth including:

- * **the press** = 新聞界／傳媒
- * **printing press** = 印刷機
- * **press release** = 新聞稿
- * **press conference** = 記者會
- * **press coverage** = 新聞報道
- * **press officer** = 新聞／傳媒聯絡主任
- * **pressed for time** = 時間緊迫
- * **hard-pressed** = 處境艱難、承受很大壓力
- * **pressing issue** = 急需處理的問題
- * **pressure** = 物理壓力／心理壓力／外界施壓
- * **pressurize** = 加壓；向某人施壓

One particularly useful compound:

> **press release**

= an official written statement given to news organizations

= **提供給新聞媒體發布的官方新聞稿**

And:

> **press conference**

= an event at which journalists ask questions

= **記者會／新聞發布會**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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press a button/key	用手指或手向按鈕／按鍵施力，使某項功能啟動
press something against something	對某物施力，使它緊貼另一個表面
press something flat/together	施加力量，使物件變平、緊密或被壓製成形
press clothes	用熨燙方式把衣物皺褶弄平
press someone	持續或強烈地催促／施壓要求某人行動
press an issue/point	持續積極地提出、追究或推動某項主張
press charges	正式要求刑事司法程序追究涉嫌犯罪行為
the press	報章、記者及新聞機構整體／新聞媒體
press — printing machine	用來大量印刷文字或圖像的機器
press — publisher	負責出版書籍或學術作品的出版機構
press — industrial machine	利用強大壓力來壓縮、塑形或加工材料的設備
press — crowd	大量人緊密擠在一起所形成的擁擠狀態／人群
pressed for time/cash	某種時間、金錢或資源不足，因而處於緊迫狀態
hard-pressed	因資源、時間或困難而承受很大壓力、處境艱難的
pressing	因重要性或時間限制而不能拖延、急需處理的
pressure — physical	施加在物體表面的力量或液體／氣體中的壓強
pressure — psychological	因責任、要求或困難而產生的心理負擔
pressure — influence	用要求、輿論或其他影響力迫使人／機構改變
pressurized — physical	內部氣體或液體被維持在特定較高壓力狀態的
pressurize someone	用心理或社會壓力迫使某人作決定

For your original sentence

> “It was like someone had **pressed a mute button** on the outside world...”

The exact meaning is:

press = 用手指向按鈕施加壓力，把它按下，從而啟動某項功能

So:

****press a mute button = 按下靜音按鈕, 啟動靜音功能****

And figuratively, the sentence means:

****戴上耳機後, 外界聲音突然大幅減弱, 感覺就像有人替整個外界按下了「靜音鍵」。****